QUICK SHEET · CONSTITUTION OF THE FEDERATED REPUBLIC

Amendments & Direct Democracy

How the people legislate directly, and how the document rewrites itself — with thresholds that climb as the change grows more permanent, some provisions entrenched against easy amendment, and one limit no amendment can ever cross.

Article XIII · §13.1–§13.2
Article XVII · §17.1–§17.4

THE PEOPLE LEGISLATE DIRECTLY — §13.1, §13.2

Optional Referendum

§13.1 · REPEAL AN ENACTED LAW

Two petition phases (State-distributed, then **5% national**), both within **20 months** of filing; the Panel decides eligibility at filing. Then a vote: **simple majority** repeals, subject to a 30–50% turnout floor set by statute. Off-limits: laws solely or primarily expanding an Article I right, budget laws, constitutionally mandated obligations. A failed referendum can't be re-run on the same grounds for 3 years.

Citizen Initiative

§13.2 · PROPOSE A NEW LAW

Two phases (State-distributed, then **10% national**) within the same **20-month** limit; the Panel checks the proposal against the limits below at filing. If the Legislature doesn't enact it within 90 days, the Panel runs a referendum within 90 days after that — passing at **60% with ≥50% participation**. The Legislature can't quietly bury a qualified proposal by ignoring it. An enacted initiative is an ordinary statute: it may not narrow an Article I right, appropriate funds, or alter revenue, with disputes resolved by the SC on petition; a failed initiative can't be re-run on the same grounds for 3 years.

THREE WAYS TO AMEND — THRESHOLDS CLIMB WITH PERMANENCE — §17.1

PARLIAMENTARY · STATE RATIFY

Legislature + States

2/3 · 2/3

2/3 of the full seated membership of both chambers, then ratification by **2/3 of States** within the statutory period (180 days until a statute sets one).

PARLIAMENTARY · POPULAR RATIFY

Legislature + the People

2/3 → 2/3

2/3 of the full seated membership of both chambers, then a national referendum at **2/3 of votes cast, ≥55% participation** within 180 days.

CITIZEN INITIATIVE

The People Alone

15% → 70%

Article XVII's exception to §7.3. The two-phase petition uses **15% national** in Phase Two, then the Panel runs a referendum within 180 days of verification, with **no legislative or executive gate**. Passage: 70% of votes cast, ≥65% participation. Any failed initiative: barred 5 years on the same or similar grounds.

WHAT'S ENTRENCHED, AND THE LINE NO AMENDMENT CROSSES — §17.1, §17.3

Entrenched Provisions §17.1

Some provisions can't be changed by the States alone — amending them **requires Popular Ratification** regardless of origin: the Monitor selection, independence, mandate, and funding guarantees (§9.1–§9.4, §9.6), the NRS architecture (§10.1), the Elections Panel / NRS Panel independence (§11.1), the non-derogable rights list (§1.19.a) and the amendment limit protecting it (§17.3(3)), the reversion of authority to the States and Territories (§15.7.a), and the entrenchment list itself. The watchdogs, the public record and the core rights can't be quietly weakened by an inter-State deal — including by first amending the list — so the people themselves must consent. A citizen initiative satisfies this through its own §17.1 referendum; no separate Popular Ratification vote is required.

The Unamendable Core §17.3

No amendment — however large its majority — **may extinguish a §1.19.a non-derogable right**. Any amendment purporting to do so is void to the extent of the extinguishment, and the SC must so rule. An amendment that meets its thresholds otherwise can't be refused, and takes only **prospective** effect. The JM publishes a consistency analysis of every amendment — advisory, but a permanent record of exactly what changed, and no parliamentary ratification vote may be held before it's published or 30 days pass, whichever comes first.

NUMBERS WORTH REMEMBERING

0 — executive role in amendments — **no signature, no veto** (§17.2). Consuls are absent from the process entirely.

5 — years a failed citizen-initiative amendment is barred from resubmission on the same or substantially similar grounds (§17.1).

70% — the ceiling: citizen-initiated amendment passage, ≥65% participation — the hardest bar in the document.

§17.4 — supremacy — every act, order, treaty, and decision must conform; anything inconsistent is **void**.

A theoretical constitutional design project — not the law of any existing nation.